

Y&NCARE

Product Story, Vision & MVP Direction

A simple, human-centered clinic access and queue-management experience for KNUST students.

Core idea: Don't make students wait at the clinic just to find out when they will be attended to.

Team working document

1. The Problem We Are Trying to Solve

Going to a clinic should be about getting care—not spending hours sitting in a queue without knowing when your turn will come.

For a KNUST student, an unexpected clinic visit can also mean missing a lecture, practical, meeting, or other important activity. The challenge is not only the medical visit itself; it is the uncertainty around when the student will actually be attended to.

YenCare is designed around a simple question: What if a student could know when to come, keep track of their place in the queue, and receive an update when their turn is approaching?

At the same time, clinic staff need a single, reliable view of appointments and queues rather than depending on paper lists or disconnected processes.

2. What YenCare Is

YenCare is a digital clinic access and queue-management platform designed for the KNUST Students' Clinic. It connects students and clinic staff around one shared workflow.

For students, YenCare should make it possible to:

- Book an appointment or join the clinic queue digitally.
- Receive a unique YenCare reference and appointment information.
- Check appointment and queue status from a phone.
- Know when they should arrive instead of waiting unnecessarily at the clinic.
- Receive important updates when their turn is approaching or their appointment changes.

For clinic staff, YenCare should provide:

- One operational view of booked, walk-in, checked-in, waiting, called, completed, and no-show patients.
- A practical way to manage the live queue.
- The ability to handle walk-ins and changing clinic schedules.
- A simple way to keep students informed when plans change.

YenCare's core promise: Reduce unnecessary physical waiting while making clinic operations easier to coordinate.

3. The Student Story

Meet Akosua

Akosua is a Level 200 KNUST student. One morning, she wakes up feeling unwell. She needs medical attention, but she also has lectures and does not want to spend several hours sitting in a clinic waiting area.

Instead of travelling immediately to the clinic, Akosua opens YenCare.

1. She identifies herself using her name, student index number, and phone number.
2. She selects the KNUST Students' Clinic.
3. She selects the type of visit she needs, such as General OPD or a follow-up/review.
4. She sees the available appointment times.
5. She chooses a suitable time and confirms the booking.
6. YenCare generates a unique reference, for example YC-4821.
7. She sees the appointment details and receives confirmation through the web interface and SMS.
8. On the day, she can check her appointment and queue status.
9. She arrives within the recommended arrival window.
10. Reception verifies her using her index number, phone number, or YenCare reference.
11. Reception checks her into the live queue.
12. YenCare shows her queue position and estimated waiting time.
13. Instead of sitting in the clinic corridor, she can wait somewhere nearby.
14. As her turn approaches, YenCare updates her and sends a notification.
15. A staff member calls her into the appropriate consultation room.
16. Her visit is completed and her YenCare status becomes Completed.

The experience we want: Akosua knows what is happening, knows where she stands, and does not have to spend unnecessary time physically waiting.

4. The Same Story From the Clinic's Side

YenCare is not only a student-facing application. It also needs to make the daily work of clinic staff easier.

Receptionist: Sees booked, walk-in, checked-in, waiting, and no-show patients in one operational queue.

Medical Officer: Sees the next verified patient and calls them into an available consultation room.

Walk-in Student: Can still receive care by being added to the same live queue after the appropriate triage process.

Student With a Schedule Conflict: Can cancel or reschedule instead of simply becoming a no-show.

Clinic Staff: Can change an appointment when clinic operations change and ensure the student is informed.

After-hours Student: Is clearly told where to seek care when the Students' Clinic is not operating rather than being allowed to book an unavailable appointment.

5. What the First Prototype Must Prove

We do not need to build everything at once. The first prototype should prove the core experience from booking through completion.

Student identity — Name, student index number, Ghana phone number, and optional NHIS number. Students should also be findable using index number, phone number, or YenCare reference.

Clinic selection — Use the real KNUST clinic location rather than a generic placeholder.

Visit type — Let the student select an appropriate service such as General OPD, Follow-up/Review, Dressing, or Other clinic service.

Emergency warning — Make it clear that normal YenCare appointments are not intended for emergencies.

Appointment confirmation — Show the reference, clinic, service, date, time, and recommended arrival time clearly.

SMS simulation — For the prototype, demonstrate the SMS experience without integrating a real SMS provider yet.

Walk-in queue — Allow reception to add students who did not book to the same live queue and generate a walk-in token.

No-show handling — Allow staff to mark appointments as no-show after the configured grace period and make the slot available again.

Staff appointment changes — Allow staff to move an appointment and show the student that the clinic has updated their time.

Multiple doctors/rooms — Support more than one clinician and consultation room so staff can call the next patient appropriately.

Live queue experience — Show the student's position, number of people ahead, estimated waiting time, and journey status.

6. The Queue Experience

This should be one of YenCare's strongest screens because it directly addresses the main problem.

YOU ARE #4 • 3 PEOPLE AHEAD • ESTIMATED WAIT: 25–35 MINUTES

The student's journey can be shown as:

- ✓ Booked
- ✓ Checked In
- ● Waiting
- ○ Called
- ○ Completed

The key message should be simple: the student does not necessarily need to remain in the waiting area. They can wait nearby and return when YenCare indicates that their turn is approaching.

7. What the Staff Dashboard Should Feel Like

The staff portal should not become a complicated analytics system. Its job is to help the clinic run the day.

Clinic Operations Dashboard

- Today's appointments
- Checked-in patients
- Patients currently waiting
- Patients who have been called
- Completed visits
- Live queue
- Number of walk-ins
- CALL NEXT action
- ADD WALK-IN action

The dashboard should answer one practical question at a glance: What is happening in the clinic right now, and what needs to happen next?

8. What Comes Later

Phase 2

- Pharmacy queue
- Laboratory queue
- Duty roster
- Closed clinic days and public holiday handling
- Arrival window and 'leave now' guidance
- Staff role permissions
- Low-data/offline confirmation
- Daily operational statistics

Future Ideas

- USSD
- SMS lookup
- Lecture-aware appointment suggestions
- Hall/college information
- Outbreak reporting
- Operational analytics
- Twi SMS

These ideas can be valuable, but they should not distract us from proving the core workflow first.

9. What YenCare Should NOT Become

Keeping the product focused is just as important as adding features. YenCare is not intended to become:

- A full hospital EMR
- A diagnosis system
- An online pharmacy

- A payment platform
- A telemedicine platform
- A patient social network
- A generic hospital management system

Our core is: Appointment + Queue + Clinic Operations + Reliable Patient Communication

10. The Complete YenCare Story

Akosua is a KNUST student who needs medical attention but has lectures and does not want to spend several hours sitting in a clinic waiting area.

She opens YenCare and identifies herself using her student index number, phone number, and name. She selects the KNUST Students' Clinic, chooses her visit type, and sees available appointments for clinicians currently on duty.

She selects an available time and confirms her appointment. YenCare generates a unique reference, YC-4821, and displays her appointment details. She also receives confirmation through SMS.

On the day of the appointment, she can check her status without travelling to the clinic unnecessarily. When she arrives, reception searches for her using her index number, phone number, or YenCare reference and checks her into the live queue.

YenCare changes her status from Booked → Checked In → Waiting and shows her queue position and estimated waiting time.

Instead of sitting in the waiting area for hours, Akosua can wait nearby. As her position approaches the front of the queue, YenCare updates her status and sends a notification.

When it is her turn, a staff member calls her and assigns her to the available consultation room. After the consultation, the visit is marked completed.

If she cannot attend, she can reschedule or cancel. If the clinic changes her appointment, staff can update it and YenCare informs her. If she arrives without an appointment, reception can add her as a walk-in to the same live queue.

For students, YenCare reduces unnecessary physical waiting. For clinic staff, it creates one shared operational view of the day's patients.

11. What Success Looks Like

For the student:

- They know when and where to go.
- They can see what is happening with their appointment.
- They spend less unnecessary time physically waiting.

- They receive important changes and queue notifications.

For clinic staff:

- They have one live queue instead of scattered lists.
- They can handle appointments and walk-ins together.
- They can respond to schedule changes.
- They can see who should be attended to next.

12. Team North Star

Whenever we are deciding whether to build a feature, we should ask: Does this help a student access care with less unnecessary waiting, or does it help clinic staff coordinate the day's patients more reliably?

If the answer is no, the feature may belong later—or may not belong in YenCare at all.

YenCare exists to make clinic access more predictable for students and clinic operations more coordinated for staff.

Source Note

This document is a humanized, team-friendly rewrite of the supplied YenCare product story. The product scope, user stories, MVP/phase structure, and core workflow are based on the source material.